

Absolutely — **anything** is a very useful grammar/polyfunctionality target because your passage uses it here:

> “...probably far beyond **anything** I could ever afford.”

Here **anything** means **any thing at all within the whole possible range**, so the phrase means:

> **遠遠超出我可能負擔得起的任何東西 / 任何金額範圍**

Grammar family: **anything / something / nothing / everything**

Base form: anything

Part of speech: indefinite pronoun (不定代名詞)

Unlike a lexical noun such as *fortune*, **anything** is mainly a grammar and meaning-range word.

Meaning in your passage: **anything = any possible thing / amount — 任何東西；任何可能範圍**

Your sentence:

> “...far beyond **anything** I could ever afford.”

Here **anything** means:

> **any thing, price, purchase, or financial possibility within the range of what I could afford**

繁體中文：

在我有能力負擔的全部可能範圍中，任何一樣東西 / 任何金額

Natural translation:

> “It would cost a fortune, probably far beyond anything I could ever afford.”

「那肯定要花上一大筆錢，恐怕遠遠超出我**可能負擔得起的任何範圍**。」

More natural:

> **「恐怕遠遠超出我的負擔能力。」**

So here:

> **anything = 任何可能負擔得起的東西 / 範圍**

1. **anything in questions = 任何東西；甚麼東西**

A core use.

Practice 1

> “Did you buy **anything** at the museum shop?”

「你有沒有在博物館商店買**甚麼東西**？」

Practice 2

> “Is there **anything** you want to ask?”

「你有**甚麼事情**想問嗎？」

anything = 在未知可能選項中，不限定是哪一樣東西

In questions, Chinese often becomes:

* 甚麼

* 任何東西

* 有沒有甚麼.....

2. **anything in negatives = 任何東西；甚麼都.....不**

A major use.

Practice 3

> “I didn’t buy **anything**.”

「我**甚麼都沒有買**。」

Practice 4

> “She couldn’t see anything in the dark.”

「她在黑暗中**甚麼都看不見**。」

anything = 在否定句中表示沒有任何一樣事物符合

Important:

- > not + anything
- > often = nothing

So:

- > “I didn’t see anything.”
- > = “I saw nothing.”

3. **anything = any thing at all, no restriction — 任何東西；甚麼都可以**

A major affirmative free-choice use.

Practice 5

- > “You can choose **anything** you like.”

「你可以選**任何你喜歡的東西**。」

Practice 6

- > “Ask me anything.”

「你**甚麼都可以問我**。」

anything = 沒有限制；任何選項都可以

This is different from question/negative polarity use.

4. **anything + relative clause = 任何符合條件的東西**

This is your source structure.

Practice 7 — Original

- > “It was beyond **anything I could afford**.”

「那超出了我**能負擔的任何範圍**。」

Practice 8

> “Choose anything that looks interesting.”

「選**任何看起來有趣的東西**。」

anything + clause = 所有符合後面條件的可能事物中，任意一樣

5. **anything but + adjective/noun = 一點也不.....；絕非.....**

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 9

> “The painting is **anything but ordinary**.”

「這幅畫**一點也不普通**。」

Practice 10

> “The process was anything but simple.”

「這個過程**絕不簡單**。」

anything but X = 完全不是 X；與 X 相反

Excellent MCQ material because the literal words can mislead.

6. **anything like + noun/adjective = 像.....；達到.....程度**

Often appears in questions/negatives.

Practice 11

> “Have you seen **anything like** this before?”

「你以前見過**類似這樣的東西**嗎？」

Practice 12

> “The reproduction is not anything like the original.”

「這幅複製品和原作**一點也不像**。」

****anything like = 與某人 / 某物相似，或達到某種程度****

In negatives:

> not anything like

> = 完全不像 / 遠遠不是

7. ****anything near / anything close to = 接近.....；差不多.....****

A useful degree use.

Practice 13

> “I can’t afford ****anything near**** that price.”

「我根本負擔不起****接近那個價位****的東西。」

Practice 14

> “The copy is not anything close to the quality of the original.”

「這個複製品的品質****遠遠比不上****原作。」

****anything near/close to = 達到接近某個程度 / 數量****

Especially common in negatives.

8. ****anything from A to B = 從 A 到 B 都可能****

A common range expression.

Practice 15

> “The repair could cost ****anything from**** five hundred ****to**** two thousand dollars.”

「維修費可能是****五百到二千元之間任何金額****。」

Practice 16

> “The exhibition may take anything from one hour to an entire afternoon.”

「參觀展覽可能需要**一小時到整個下午不等**。」

****anything from A to B = 可能是 A 至 B 範圍內的任何數值 / 情況****

9. ****anything up to + amount = 最高可達；任何不超過.....的數量****

Practice 17

> “The frame could cost ****anything up to**** five thousand dollars.”

「那個畫框的價格****最高可能達到五千元****。」

Practice 18

> “Delivery can take anything up to two weeks.”

「送貨時間****最長可能需要兩星期****。」

****anything up to X = 從較低數值到 X 為止的任何數量；最高可達 X****

10. ****anything else = 其他任何東西；還有別的嗎****

A very common pattern.

Practice 19

> “Would you like ****anything else****?”

「你還需要****其他東西嗎****？」

Practice 20

> “I don't need anything else.”

「我不需要****其他任何東西****。」

****anything else = 除了已提及事物之外的其他任何東西****

11. ****anything more = 更多任何東西；還有更多嗎****

Practice 21

> “Do you want to know **anything more**?”

「你還想知道**更多東西嗎**？」

Practice 22

> “I can’t add anything more.”

「我不能再補充**更多內容**了。」

anything more = 額外的任何事物 / 內容

12. **anything at all** = 任何東西都；哪怕一點點

An emphatic form.

Practice 23

> “If you need **anything at all**, call me.”

「如果你需要**任何東西**，不管是甚麼，就打給我。」

Practice 24

> “I couldn’t hear anything at all.”

「我**完全甚麼都聽不見**。」

anything at all = 強調「任何可能的東西 / 一點點都包括」

13. **anything possible** = 任何可能的事

Practice 25

> “We’ll do **anything possible** to protect the painting.”

「我們會做**任何可能做到的事**來保護這幅畫。」

Practice 26

> “She tried anything possible to solve the problem.”

「她嘗試了**所有可能的方法**去解決問題。」

anything possible = 任何在現實上可行的事情

14. **anything to do with + topic = 與.....有任何關係**

A very common construction.

Practice 27

> “Does this have **anything to do with** the exhibition?”

「這跟展覽**有任何關係嗎**？」

Practice 28

> “The delay had nothing to do with the museum.”

「延誤跟博物館**完全沒有關係**。」

anything to do with = 與某主題、人或事情有任何關聯

This is a fixed pattern rather than a new lexical meaning.

15. **if anything = 如果要說的話；反而；甚至可以說**

A high-value discourse expression.

Practice 29

> “The second version is not brighter; **if anything**, it is darker.”

「第二個版本並沒有更亮；**如果要說的話，反而更暗**。」

Practice 30

> “The room did not feel smaller. If anything, it felt more open.”

「房間並沒有感覺更小；**反而**覺得更開揚。」

****if anything = 若真要作比較 / 補充，實際情況反而更接近後面的說法****

Excellent MCQ material.

16. ****or anything = 或其他類似東西；之類的****

A conversational use.

Practice 31

> “I didn’t buy a poster ****or anything****.”

「我沒有買海報****或其他甚麼東西****。」

Practice 32

> “We didn’t discuss money or anything.”

「我們沒有談錢****之類的事****。」

****or anything = 或其他同類 / 相關事物；之類的****

Register: conversational.

17. ****like anything = 非常地；拼命地 (BrE informal) ****

A secondary idiomatic use.

Practice 33

> “It was raining ****like anything****.”

「雨下得****非常大****。」

Practice 34

> “She was working like anything to finish on time.”

「她為了準時完成而****拼命工作****。」

****like anything = 程度非常強烈****

Register:

- * informal
- * especially BrE
- * secondary recognition use

18. **for anything = 無論如何都..... (常見於否定) **

Practice 35

> “I wouldn’t sell the painting **for anything**.”

「我**無論如何都不會**賣掉這幅畫。」

Practice 36

> “She wouldn’t miss the exhibition for anything.”

「她**說甚麼也不會**錯過這個展覽。」

not ... for anything = 無論給甚麼條件 / 代價都不會.....

19. **anything goes = 甚麼都可以 ; 沒有太多限制**

A common fixed expression.

Practice 37

> “In this creative exercise, **anything goes**.”

「在這個創意練習中 , **甚麼都可以**。」

Practice 38

> “There are almost no rules — anything goes.”

「幾乎沒有規則 , **怎樣都可以**。」

anything goes = 幾乎沒有規範或限制 , 任何做法都可以接受

Important distinction: **anything** vs **something**

something

= 某樣東西，說話者通常假設 / 認為有一樣東西存在。

anything

= 不限定是哪一樣，或用於問題、否定、自由選擇。

Compare:

> "I saw **something**."

= 我看到**某樣東西**。

> "Did you see **anything**?"

= 你有看到**甚麼東西嗎**？

Important distinction: **anything** vs **nothing**

anything in a negative sentence:

> "I didn't see anything."

nothing in an affirmative grammatical structure:

> "I saw nothing."

Both mean:

「我甚麼都沒看見。」

In standard English, avoid double negative:

> *I didn't see nothing.* ❌

> in formal standard usage.

Important distinction: **anything** vs **everything**

anything

= any one thing / no restriction on which.

everything

= all things.

> “You can choose anything.”

= 任何一樣都可以選。

> “You can’t choose everything.”

= 不可能全部都選。

Important distinction: **anything vs any thing**

Normally:

> **anything** = one word

Use separate **any thing** only when **thing** is specifically being contrasted or modified in an unusual way.

For normal English:

> “Do you need anything?” 

not:

> *any thing* 

Important distinction: **anything in questions vs free-choice anything**

Question:

> “Did you see anything?”

= 有沒有看到甚麼？

The speaker does not know whether such a thing exists.

Free choice:

> “Choose anything.”

= 任何東西都可以。

Here it means:

> no restriction whatsoever.

Same form, different semantic force.

Important distinction: **anything but vs nothing but**

These are almost opposites.

anything but

= definitely not

> “The room was anything but quiet.”

= 房間一點也不安靜。

nothing but

= only

> “The room contained nothing but paintings.”

= 房間裡除了畫甚麼都沒有。

Excellent MCQ trap.

Important distinction: **anything like vs something like**

anything like

often appears in questions/negatives:

> “Have you seen anything like it?”

= 見過類似的嗎？

something like

often means:

* approximately

* something resembling

> “It cost something like \$3,000.”

= 大約 3,000 元。

Different typical usage.

Important distinction: **anything near vs nearly**

anything near

often in negatives:

= 接近某程度

> “It isn’t anything near perfect.”

= 遠遠談不上完美。

nearly

= almost

> “It is nearly finished.”

= 差不多完成。

Important distinction: **anything + adjective**

Indefinite pronouns normally put adjectives **after** them:

> anything interesting 

> anything useful 

> anything expensive 

not:

> *interesting anything* ❌

Same pattern:

- * something new
- * nothing unusual
- * everything important

This is very useful grammar.

Important distinction: **anything + singular reference**

Although **anything** is semantically broad, it is grammatically singular:

> “Anything **is** possible.”

not:

> *Anything are possible.* ❌

Pronoun reference can naturally use singular **it**:

> “If anything is damaged, report it.”

Grammar/family sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **anything — questions** = 甚麼 / 任何東西
- * **anything — negatives** = 任何東西；甚麼都.....
- * **anything — free choice** = 任何東西都可以
- * **anything + relative clause** = 任何符合條件的東西
- * **anything but** = 一點也不 / 絕非
- * **anything like** = 像..... / 接近.....
- * **anything near/close to** = 接近某程度
- * **anything from A to B** = A 至 B 之間任何可能
- * **anything up to** = 最高可達
- * **anything else** = 其他任何東西
- * **anything more** = 更多內容 / 東西
- * **anything at all** = 任何東西都 / 哪怕一點點

* **anything possible** * = 任何可能做到的事
 * **anything to do with** * = 與.....有任何關係
 * **if anything** * = 如果要說的話，反而.....
 * **or anything** * = 或其他類似東西 / 之類
 * **like anything** * = 非常地 (BrE informal)
 * **not ... for anything** * = 無論如何都不.....
 * **anything goes** * = 甚麼都可以

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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anything — question	在未知選項中詢問是否存在任何一樣事物
anything — negative	否定範圍涵蓋所有可能事物；甚麼都沒有 / 不.....
anything — free choice	沒有限定哪一項；任何一樣都可以
anything + clause	所有符合後面條件的可能事物中任意一樣
anything but	完全不是；一點也不
anything like	與某物相似 / 達到類似程度
anything near/close to	達到接近某個數量或程度
anything from A to B	A 至 B 範圍內任何可能的數值 / 情況
anything up to	數值可能從較低範圍一直到指定上限
anything else	除已提及事物之外的其他任何東西
anything at all	強調任何可能事物都包括；哪怕一點點
if anything	若真要作比較，實際情況反而更接近後面的說法
or anything	或其他相關 / 同類事物；之類的
not ... for anything	無論有甚麼條件或代價都不願做某事
anything goes	幾乎沒有規限；任何做法都可接受

For your original sentence

> “It would cost a fortune, probably far beyond **anything** I could ever afford.”

The exact meaning is:

anything = 在我一生中有可能買得起 / 負擔得起的所有東西或價格範圍中，任何一樣

Natural translation is better expressed as:

> **「那肯定要花上一大筆錢，恐怕遠遠超出我的負擔能力。」**

rather than mechanically:

> **「遠遠超出任何我能負擔的東西。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****Do you need anything?**** → 你需要甚麼嗎？
- > ****I didn't buy anything.**** → 我甚麼都沒有買
- > ****Choose anything.**** → 任何東西都可以選
- > ****anything I can afford**** → 任何我負擔得起的東西
- > ****anything but ordinary**** → 一點也不普通
- > ****anything like the original**** → 像原作那樣 / 接近原作
- > ****anything from \$3,000 to \$5,000**** → 3,000 至 5,000 元不等
- > ****if anything**** → 如果要說的話，反而.....
- > ****anything vs something**** → 任何 / 甚麼 vs 某樣東西
- > ****anything vs everything**** → 任一 / 任何 vs 全部